

ISO 9001:2015 · AUDIT PREPARATION COMPANION

Audit Preparation Companion

Example Ltd

Mechanical and electrical building services specialist for schools, NHS facilities, offices and industrial units in the Coventry, West Midlands area.

Locale	en-GB
Prepared for	Gareth Pryce
Companion to	Quality Management System Manual · Example Ltd v1.0

This companion is tailored for Example Ltd's ISO 9001 Stage 2 audit preparation. It provides auditor-focused, company-specific checklists and guidance — based directly on your manual content, roles, KPIs and live processes. Use it to collect targeted evidence, track timing requirements, and structure your final preparations before audit.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTER 4

Context, Interested Parties & QMS Scope

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Can you describe how Example Ltd determined the scope of its quality management system, and which activities or sites are included?
- ☐ Which external requirements — such as CDM, BS 7671, or Gas Safe registration — directly influence your QMS and how do you ensure compliance on every project?
- ☐ Show how risks such as delayed materials, incomplete test documentation, or expired CSCS/ECS cards are identified, assessed and controlled under your QMS.
- ☐ Who are your key interested parties — for example, main contractors, NHS and public-sector clients — and how do you capture their requirements in your processes?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Quality management system scope statement or documented summary, covering all operational sites and activities (commercial and public-sector buildings, installation and maintenance, aftercare).
- ☐ Register, list, or documented references for relevant statutory and regulatory requirements (e.g. CDM, BS 7671, Gas Safe, CSCS/ECS).
- ☐ Risk and opportunity records or registers, including assessment of supply chain, handover, and compliance risks relevant to your work on live sites.
- ☐ Examples of how interested party requirements (e.g. main contractor deadlines, NHS standards) are identified and translated into site plans and documentation checks.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ The scope and context analysis should be current and reflect live operational activities at the point of audit (not more than 12 months old).
- ☐ Risk assessments and registers should be reviewed regularly, and at least prior to each management review (typically annually, or after significant changes).
- ☐ Evidence of compliance with external requirements should be up-to-date (e.g. certificates held, licences valid, registers current at time of audit).
- ☐ Retain documents and evidence for as long as required by UK statutory or contractual requirements ("as per applicable national requirements", unless otherwise specified).

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Review your documented QMS scope; update to match all current activities and sites covered by Example Ltd, reflecting any new client types or building functions.
- ☐ Compile and update your list of statutory, regulatory, and client-specific requirements; ensure this is referenced in project plans and handover packs.
- ☐ Gather examples of recent risk assessments and risk reviews for live projects (focus on areas such as material supply, documentation, and compliance risks).
- ☐ Collect completed project checklists or communications showing how client and contractor expectations are identified and incorporated into project planning.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTER 5

Leadership & Responsibilities

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Show the signed quality policy for Example Ltd. When was it last communicated and who is responsible for ensuring staff understand it?
- ☐ How are your three main quality objectives — on-time completion, snag reduction, and documentation at handover — set, tracked, and reviewed biannually by management?
- ☐ Describe the roles of Gareth Pryce, Lee Hammond, Joanne Clarke, and Ricky Obeng in leading, supporting, and monitoring the QMS, and how responsibility for corrective action is assigned and followed up.
- ☐ Provide an example where management (e.g. spring review led by Gareth Pryce) has set new actions based on actual performance against KPIs.

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Signed and dated quality policy, document version control record, and communication record (e.g. noticeboard posting, team briefing notes).
- ☐ Records of quality objectives, their targets (e.g. 95% programme date, 10 or fewer snags per job, 100% commissioning/test pack at handover), and progress reviews.
- ☐ Management review minutes where objectives, performance, and actions have been discussed and assigned to named persons.
- ☐ Organisation chart or up-to-date role descriptions for Gareth Pryce, Lee Hammond, Joanne Clarke, Ricky Obeng, showing QMS responsibilities.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Quality policy should be current, signed, and communicated within the last 12 months or after any policy change.
- ☐ Objectives and reviews: tracked at least biannually and at each management review, with evidence spanning the previous 6–12 months.
- ☐ Role descriptions and organisational QMS responsibilities must be up to date at audit time.
- ☐ Retain management review records and policy documents for as long as required by UK law and contractual practice (typically several years, but confirm for client contracts).

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Obtain a signed copy of your current quality policy and ensure it's visible to all staff and discussed at an all-hands or pre-start briefing.
- ☐ Review and document progress on KPI objectives; collect up-to-date completion and snagging data for the last 6–12 months.
- ☐ Prepare management review minutes — highlight action tracking, and include sign-off from Gareth Pryce or another authorised person.
- ☐ Update and circulate clear QMS role descriptions for all named persons; ensure coverage for periods of absence.

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Walk me through a recent project — from tender to handover — showing how Example Ltd controls procurement, delivery, and site documentation. Who checks that commissioning and test packs are completed before handover?
- ☐ How are materials received on site checked, and what happens if there are shortages, incorrect items, or quality issues? Who handles supplier complaints and feedback?
- ☐ Show how document control is managed: who maintains the project file and ensures only current drawings and specifications are used? How are obsolete or superseded documents controlled?
- ☐ How do you ensure all operatives and subcontractors (including temporary staff) are qualified and inducted before starting on site? Who controls records of CSCS/ECS cards and Gas Safe registrations?
- ☐ Describe your control of test equipment calibration. Can you provide calibration certificates and the register maintained by Ricky Obeng?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Procurement and delivery records for one or more recent projects, showing supplier orders, delivery notes, and chain of communication for resolving shortages or quality issues (Joanne Clarke's records).
- ☐ Completed test certificates and commissioning records, with evidence of timely completion and sign-off (on or before handover), including signatures from authorised personnel.
- ☐ Document control registers showing version status, distribution, and removal of superseded documents (maintained by Joanne Clarke).
- ☐ Supplier evaluation records or feedback logs, with evidence of annual (even if informal) reviews — showing any supplier change due to delivery or quality issues.
- ☐ Qualifications and induction records for site staff (register of CSCS/ECS/Gas Safe cards), plus induction and toolbox talk sign-in sheets.
- ☐ Calibration certificates for all critical test instruments and plant (register kept by Ricky Obeng).

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Project/process evidence must be live: drawn from real jobs active within the last 3–6 months prior to the audit (not just examples prepared for the auditor).
- ☐ Documented controls should show regular (ongoing) management — e.g., calibration registers updated annually, document control checks at every revision, supplier records annually reviewed.
- ☐ Staff qualification and induction records should be maintained continuously, with no gap for anyone currently working on site.
- ☐ Calibration records: must be valid (i.e., not expired) at time of audit; annual calibration evidence required for each instrument currently in use.
- ☐ Document retention should comply with UK legal/insurance or contract standards — usually at least 6 years for project documentation, unless otherwise stipulated by the client.

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Select a recent full project (from tender to handover) and gather all related evidence: programme, material order, delivery/inspection records, site briefings, commissioning and test packs, snagging lists, completion/Handover documentation.
- ☐ Prepare document control records: latest control register, evidence of superseded document removal and controlled issue to site teams.
- ☐ Update and check supplier and plant registers (include calibration records, supplier performance notes, and any recent change of supplier due to performance issues).
- ☐ Review and prepare up-to-date staff qualification and induction records for all operatives and apprentices involved on site within the last 3–6 months.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTERS 9–10

Internal Audit, Management Review & Improvement

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Show records of your most recent internal audit: who planned it, who carried it out, which processes were sampled, and what non-conformities or improvement points were raised?
- ☐ How are actions from audit findings assigned and followed up? Who tracks their closure and how is this reported at management review?
- ☐ Provide management review minutes from the last 6–12 months. What were the key topics discussed, and what changes resulted from KPI analysis or repeated issues?
- ☐ Show a corrective action (e.g. relating to repeated snagging or supplier performance) that has been closed. How was its effectiveness verified?
- ☐ How do staff raise improvement suggestions or report issues? Give an example of a process improvement that came out of staff input or recurring problems.

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Internal audit schedule and the most recent completed audit reports, including checklists, findings, and auditor name (typically Joanne Clarke with support from Gareth Pryce, plus subject-specific checks by Ricky Obeng or Lee Hammond).
- ☐ Corrective action log/register, showing non-conformities logged, actions assigned (with owner and due date), progress tracked and status closed out.
- ☐ Management review minutes, signed and dated by Gareth Pryce, with attendee list (e.g. Lee Hammond, Joanne Clarke, Ricky Obeng), agenda (KPIs, audit findings, supplier performance, risk analysis), and action log.
- ☐ Register or record of improvement suggestions or recurring issues (from toolbox talks or team briefings), with evidence of analysis and any subsequent changes in process or procedure.
- ☐ Evidence of verification for closed corrective actions (e.g. follow-up audit, checks, or feedback confirming effectiveness).

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Internal audits: must be planned and carried out at least annually and before Stage 2 audit, covering all core processes over a cycle.
- ☐ Management review: must be held at planned intervals, in practice at least annually; evidence from past 6–12 months required.
- ☐ Corrective action log should show live tracking, with actions closed within agreed timescales and effectiveness checked/reviewed before closure.
- ☐ Evidence for Stage 2 must relate to actual live operation for at least 3 months, not just “created for the audit”.
- ☐ Improvement and corrective action records should be retained as per UK statutory and contractual requirements.

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Plan and deliver an internal audit cycle covering all core and support processes (e.g. project delivery, supplier management, document control). Assign independent auditors, and record findings, actions and evidence.
- ☐ Update and check the corrective action log: ensure that actions have clear owners (named persons), deadlines, and closure evidence. Prepare to evidence real cases from the last 3–6 months.
- ☐ Prepare management review minutes, with signed attendance; highlight how KPI data, audit reports, supplier issues, and process risks are reviewed and actions agreed.
- ☐ Gather documentation showing how staff can and do raise improvement suggestions (toolbox talks, direct feedback, staff meetings), and at least one example where change was implemented and its effectiveness checked.

